The Future of Work

Have you ever considered how integral labour is in the development of humanity? Every minutia of society's morals, every brick of the popular churches, every clause in governmental contracts, and, of course, every hour spent on the clock, all efforts in advancing this race. But with advancement comes efficiency, and some believe there comes a point where the creator shapes something that can outperform him. Luckily, humanity has not quite developed such an advanced product, although the recent innovations in artificial intelligence make many worry. Albeit, it is undoubtable that such a piece of technology has already greatly and perhaps permanently affected the job market, for better, or for worse.

First and foremost, what jobs, specifically, would be affected by AI? Well, initial trends are rather misleading, but it is still important to note that the tech sector was hit particularly hard: Microsoft laid off over 15000 employees in 2025, 40% of which were software engineers (Medium 2025). More reliably, however, administrative roles, data analysts, and middle-management positions seem to be most at-risk. Luckily (and ironically), it seems like the job market is starting to bounce back from this craze. The Bureau of Labor Statistics projects a 17.9% increase in positions for software developers over the next 7 years, with many other tech-related jobs following similar patterns, such as database architects (10.8%) and database administrators (8.2%). But how exactly is AI accomplishing this? Is it some sort of miracle worker that does it all, stomping all "old" jobs in its wake, leaving only the bare minimum to keep itself afloat?

Fortunately (although some may argue otherwise), that is far from the case. In technical truth, AI is not even non-deterministic, although the factors involved in its processing and output

are so complex that it might as well be. This complexity also extends towards its training data. Modern AI applications such as large language models (LLMs) have a ridiculous sample pool. For instance, per Balaji N. of Cyber Security News in 2025, Meta trained its Llama AI models using 81.7 terabytes of books from torrent libraries, and that's just a fraction of what the models were fed. Although such a large collection of data does allow for monotonous or simple tasks that require simple pattern repetition, AI products start to fail when more refined technique is required. Critical analysis, for instance, is not simply a skill learned through reading books. One must first understand the content at hand before making an evaluation of it, and AI can do no such thing because it is simply not sapient nor sentient. So then, if the key distinction between an AI and a human is the ability to understand, how may one use this to their advantage to stick out in a job market already swindled by AI? Or rather, how can students stay competitive?

There are two distinct "groups" of skills that students should develop to remain competitive in the modern job market. The first group includes any skills that directly relate to working with AI: prompt engineering, task breakdowns, and AI literacy. Students should familiarise themselves with using AI because, whether they like it or not, most jobs will want them to do such. However, to incorporate AI into their workflow effectively requires an understanding of its limitations. Being able to break down complex situations into smaller, less complex and abstract problems opens up opportunities for artificial intelligence to speed up the overall workflow. Obviously, also having the ability to evaluate an AI's solutions is essential to streamlining the workflow effectively. The latter group, on the other hand, contains skills that are simply beyond the capacity for AI to work through: critical thinking, narrative curation, and persuasion are among the most paramount. As previously established, AI does not have the ability to understand content, and so it cannot critically evaluate a problem. Narrative curation,

such as building out scenarios relating to the problem at hand and then extrapolating solutions from those scenarios is also beyond an AI's capacity of accuracy. Persuasion, and really communication in general, is, arguably, the most essential, though. To nail an interview, not only do people have to have the proper qualifications, but they must make themselves notable to distinguish themselves from a crowd of other qualified candidates, and the best way to do this is to simply be charismatic: have a warm greeting, joke when appropriate, act within the atmosphere. These characteristics can be described by any AI, but they will never be able to replicate it (at least, hopefully so).

Overall, the craze of artificial intelligence, while beginning to simmer down, has still greatly affected the job market. The tech sector, once greatly reduced, has begun to rebound, although the same can't be said for any jobs involving monotonous actions, like many middle-management positions. This is because AI is especially good at executing these simple tasks at speeds simply above any human. Although it is imperfect, and so it is important that students know both how to work with AI and how to work without it to truly stand out in the modern job market.

Works Cited

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AI Log

Date: 3/9/26

Tool Used: ChatGPT

Task: Provide a list of jobs that will grow and shrink in size based on the advancements of AI.

Prompt: Which jobs are most likely to go into semi-automation or full automation and which jobs are projected to grow with the current rise of AI? Please list any sources.

Output Quality: 3

Fact-Check Results: Scanned sources, looked for bits of information regarding such, checked trustworthiness of sources.

How Used In Paper: I just stole two of its sources for myself to use (medium.com and bls.gov)

Date: 3/9/26

Tool Used: ChatGPT

Task: Provide a list of jobs that will grow and shrink in size based on the advancements of AI.

Prompt: I'm a college student writing an essay about how AI is impacting the future job market and what students should do to remain competitive. My first body paragraph's topic goes over actual statistics for job fields growing and shrinking, but I'm struggling with a follow-up topic. What next should I cover, and after that (for my second and third bodies)?

Output Quality: 4

Fact-Check Results: N/A

How Used In Paper: I took some of its advice and “cropped” (for lack of a better term) it to suit my paper better (IE: it said I should cover why and how AI is changing jobs. I am not going to

cover the why directly but just the how). Basically, I extrapolated the topics for my second and third paragraphs from it.

Date: 3/10/26

Tool Used: ChatGPT

Task: Provide a list of skills students should develop to stick out to jobs already embracing AI.

Prompt: What skills should students develop to remain competitive in a market swindled by AI?

Output Quality: 4

Fact-Check Results: N/A

How Used In Paper: I evaluated the list and chose what I thought would be best for students to develop.

Reflection

ChatGPT was most helpful because it was the only one I used. I wasn't really surprised about AI capabilities/limitations, I have a pretty good handle on what it can and can't do. Using AI changed my research and writing process as I was able to find related articles on my paper very easily. My concern is overreliance on it. I will be using AI tools sparingly. Like before, I would always just use it when I struggled with topic ideas and couldn't think of something else. That's about it, being forced to use it to research I think very much negatively impacted both my enjoyment of writing this essay and the content of the essay itself. I just don't like using AI tools for anything other than brainstorming.